

Impact Medium · Difficulty Easy · Misuse risk Medium

THE MOVE

Specific thing -> Why it stood out -> Stop

START HERE

Give one compliment today that names the specific thing you observed and why it mattered to you. Do not add qualifiers or requests after it.

SAY THIS

Specific Praise	<i>"The way you handled that question in the meeting was sharp."</i>
Impact Phrases	<i>"It made the difference in how the meeting landed."</i>
Quick Compliments	<i>"Good catch on that error."</i>
Professional Praise	<i>"Your analysis changed my mind on the timeline — I came in believing the opposite."</i>
Praise Under Pressure	<i>"Before I push back on the plan: the thinking behind it is genuinely strong."</i>

AVOID

- When you are fishing for a reciprocal compliment — the motive will be sensed.
- In formal performance reviews where specific praise can inadvertently exclude other positive qualities.
- When the compliment is about something outside the person's control rather than their choices or skill.

REMEMBER

Name the moment, not the person.